



What does the consequentialist say that David ought to do in this case?

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This sort of case might lead you to think something like this: killing someone in order to save the lives of others is never morally permissible.

But, as some of Thomson's other examples show, matters are not quite this simple.

If this were true, this looks like it would be trouble for the Consequentialist, since it is hard to argue that killing someone, especially when it saves the lives of others, can never lead to an outcome which is, overall, the best of the available options.

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Consider one of the examples involving a trolley car: